reflective of the wider social debates concerning the place of religious ideology in Pakistan. This was clearly evident in the rivalry between the Islami Jamiat-e-Tuleba (known as the Jamiat), which was linked to Maulana Mawdudi's Jamaat-e-Islami and the DSF (see also Akhtar 2018). However, Nelson in his study illustrates how other identities had also persisted from the 'sectarian' nature of the 'Imamia Student's Organization', and the 'regional' nature of the 'Baloch Students Organization and the Pakhtun Students Federation' (2011, p. 567). The Ministry of Education in 1966 in fact had its own categorization of the student societies, distinguishing between the East and West Pakistan student organizations. These included both 'recognized' organizations that were clearly affiliated with a university and 'unrecognized' organizations that were believed to be independent, in which the DSF, the now largely leftist NSF and the Jamiat were also implicated.[4] The 'unrecognized' organizations were blamed for the violence and chaos that erupted on student campuses (Ministry of Education 1966). The DSF in particular through the ICB was instrumental in organizing what was called the '8th of January movement' (Bajwa 2015, p. 12).

Student violence: Demands Day – 7–9 January 1953

Student political organizations had a complicated relationship with the state, with some under the patronage of the state depending on the ruling party and others often at loggerheads. The threat posed by opposing student groups to the ruling elite is evident in the strong-armed tactics of the police in repressing the Demands Day movement of 1953, which incited greater resentment and violence. The 8 January movement involves one of the earliest student clashes with the police; it resulted in the death and injury of students and protestors in 1953. The students had local education grievances which continued to be ignored by the university administration despite constant appeals.[5] The students further appealed to Education Minister Fazlur Rahman, who also did not respond to their requests, resulting in a resolution being passed by university unions 'demanding their basic rights and asking Minister to meet the ICB members' (Herald Student, 1953). The students decided to hold a 'Demands Day' on 7 January, leading a peaceful procession to meet the education minister. In the events that followed between 7 and 9 January, the police clashed with student protestors, using live ammunition on students and killing seven and injuring several others (Bajwa 2015). As news of the police brutality spread, 'several processions were taken out by students across Pakistan, with solidarity protests' across 'cities of West and East Pakistan throughout the year 1953'